

Level Up

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(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- (c) Discuss the characteristics of tribal economy. Also discuss typology of tribal economy in India by L.P. Vidyarthi and Majumdar. (20 marks)

Prof. J.P. Vidyarthi in "Tribal Development and its administration (1981)" defined a tribe as

- a social group with
- I. Defined territory
 - II. Common name
 - III. Distinct culture
 - IV. Distinctive socio-political system
 - V. Self sufficient economy

CHARACTERISTICS of TRIBAL ECONOMY

- i) Non-monetary based → mostly a barter system as well as reciprocity, redistribution and ceremonial exchange.

eg. Joda ↔ Betta
 ↔ Kurumba } Reciprocity

- ii) Mostly self sufficient → majority of goods needed are procured from forests

- iii) No specialised institutions for transfer of money

- iv) Embedded in social and cultural matrix and modern economic laws not applicable.

g: Utility maximisation
Rational decisions > - Inapplicable

- v) Minimal presence of bargains and diversity of products
- vi) Lack of large market access

CHANGES

- ① Many tribal products are getting sold through online e-commerce platforms, thus increasing customer base
g - Amazon sells on GAADHKA platform
- survival International
- ② Increased penetration of Market Economy
g - BONDA (Orissa) now come from their forest homes to weekly haats

Prof J.P. Vidyasthi and J.N. Majumdar classified the tribals economy in 'TRIBAL CULTURE OF INDIA'

① Hunting and gathering - e.g. Chenchu, Birhor

- subsistence economy
- loose division of labour (women too hunt)

② Pastoralists - e.g. Bhotia, Bakarwals

- keep animals along with agricultural
- mostly settled. Some do transhumance where they move to lower region in winter

③ Artist e.g. Nat, Jha, Iwala (Snake charmers)

- this livelihood is increasingly difficult due to modern means of entertainment

④ Shifting cultivation : e.g. hill tribes - Gano, Khasi

- slash and burn agriculture
- production is for subsistence and not storage

⑤ Horticulturists : e.g. Jeyma Naga,

- women dominated economy where fruits and flowers are grown
- allows a small surplus

⑥ Agricultural tribes

→ They produce crops and earn via selling
It in nearby market

Today many tribal economies are disrupted due to

- ① monetized economy
- ② broadly as disrupted tribes
- ③ encroachment by outsiders

Tribal economy is a cultural heritage
and must be supported, not uprooted.

Marks:

Comment:

Intro:

Body:

Conclusion:

Total:

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